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DJIA 48977.18 ▲ 594.79 1.23% NASDAQ 23395.82 ▲ 0.7% STOXX 600 601.76 ▲ 0.9% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 6/32, yield 4.164% OIL \$58.32 ▲ \$1.00 GOLD \$4,436.90 ▲ \$122.50 EURO \$1.1723 YEN 156.40

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The Trump administration** won international policy concessions sought by Republicans and companies to reshape a global corporate minimum-tax deal without abandoning it. **A1**
- ◆ **U.S. stocks began** the year's first full week of trading with a kick that lifted the Dow 1.2% to a record and the S&P 500 and Nasdaq by 0.6% and 0.7%, respectively. **B1**
- ◆ **GM and several rivals** reported year-end sales slumps, a sign that U.S. vehicle sales will slow this year as consumers resist higher prices. **B1**
- ◆ **AT&T, the sixth-biggest** employer in Dallas, is planning to relocate its global headquarters from the city center to the nearby suburb of Plano. **B1**
- ◆ **U.S. factory activity** fell in December, defying expectations, amid a pullback in production and inventories, a survey of manufacturing firms shows. **A2**
- ◆ **Universal Music** will acquire a minority stake in Indian movie and digital content studio Excel, boosting its presence in a market with high growth potential. **B3**
- ◆ **Bed Bath & Beyond** appointed its executive chairman of the board, Marcus Lemonis, as its new chief executive. **B2**
- ◆ **The highest tariffs** in almost a century haven't caused the huge surge in inflation many economists feared, but that shouldn't come as a surprise, according to two new studies. **A2**
- ◆ **Novo Nordisk's Wegovy** weight-loss pill is now broadly available across the U.S. two weeks after it received U.S. regulatory approval, the Danish drugmaker said. **B3**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Ousted Venezuelan** President Nicolás Maduro pleaded not guilty to drug-trafficking charges at his arraignment in U.S. federal court in New York City, defiantly telling a judge that he was still the head of his nation. **A1, A5, A8**
- ◆ **A profitable bet** by an unknown trader on Polymarket closely timed to Maduro's downfall fueled suspicions of insider trading. **A8**
- ◆ **ICE plans to send** more than 2,000 personnel to Minnesota, where a multiyear social-services fraud scandal has continued to grow. **A3**
- ◆ **The Pentagon moved** to demote Sen. Mark Kelly, a retired captain in the U.S. Navy, over his participation in a video calling on troops to reject illegal orders. **A4**
- ◆ **The U.S. is dropping** universal recommendations for certain childhood vaccines, in a stark overhaul of the immunization schedule and vaccine policy generally. **A3**
- ◆ **The Health and Human** Services Department endorsed the use of self-administered tests for the virus that causes cervical cancer, to increase access to screening. **A3**
- ◆ **A meeting between** China's Xi Jinping and South Korean leader Lee Jae Myung highlighted a pivot in Beijing's attitude toward North Korea's nuclear weapons. **A9**
- ◆ **A man was taken into** custody after allegedly damaging the Ohio home of Vice President JD Vance, the Secret Service said. **A2**
- ◆ **Died: Michael Schumacher**, 75, wide-ranging author. **A2**

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‘I Am Innocent,’ Maduro Tells Judge



STERMAN/NEWSCOM/ZUMA PRESS

Nicolás Maduro and his wife, Cilia Flores, were led out of a helicopter Monday in cuffs on their way to federal court in Manhattan.

Ousted Venezuelan leader calls himself prisoner of war at hearing in New York

By CORINNE RAMEY
AND JAMES FANELLI

Ousted Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro pleaded not guilty to drug-trafficking charges during his arraignment in U.S. federal court in New York City on Monday, defiantly telling a judge that he was still the head of his nation despite being whisked away by U.S. forces over the weekend.

“I am innocent. I’m not guilty. I’m a decent man. I’m still the president of my country,” he said through a Spanish interpreter, adding that he was a prisoner of war and had been kidnapped from his home in Caracas.

Maduro’s top lieutenant, Delcy Rodríguez, was sworn in as Venezuela’s acting president Monday, as remnants of the regime moved swiftly to assert control. Security officers were out in force in Caracas, running checkpoints and patrolling neighborhoods to prevent protests.

The raid in which Maduro was arrested generated criticism Monday at the United Nations, where the U.S. was accused by several countries of violating global rules and norms it helped craft. French envoy Jay Dharmadhikari said an act that contravenes U.N. principles “chips away the very foundation of international order.”

In Manhattan, Monday’s hearing kicked off a nearly unprecedented legal battle over a

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Oil and Money

- ◆ **Greg Ip: Trump debuts** ‘Donroe Doctrine’..... **A6**
- ◆ **Trader made windfall** on Maduro’s downfall..... **A8**
- ◆ **Heard on the Street: Oil** shrugs off shock..... **B10**

Trump’s Approach to the Americas: Speak Loudly and Carry a Big Stick

President signals the U.S. is returning to a policy and an era of interventions

The U.S. might have decided it no longer wants to be the world’s policeman, but the

By *David Luhnow,*
Juan Forero and
Vera Bergengruen

military operation that captured Venezuela’s autocratic president shows it is far more

willing now to be the enforcer in its own hemisphere.

President Trump’s audacious decision to seize Nicolás Maduro from his Caracas compound and whisk him to New York to stand trial on drugs and weapons charges heralds a new geopolitical strategy: The U.S. and the U.S. only will dominate the Western Hemisphere.

For the Trump administration, that is Washington’s core interest, a vision laid out recently in its national-security strategy. In the wake of Maduro’s arrest, Trump has warned Colombia’s leftist presi-

dent that he could be next, said Cuba’s regime was likely to fall soon of its own accord, and again raised the idea that the U.S. should control Greenland.

“American dominance in the Western Hemisphere will never be questioned again,” Trump said Monday. Hours later, the State Department put out a picture of Trump emblazoned with the headline: “This is OUR hemisphere,” echoing Trump’s hard-edged rhetoric in an unusually blunt tone for the nation’s diplomatic agency.

Call it a return of the “Big Stick” school of hemispheric

relations, a throwback to U.S. President Theodore Roosevelt.

The policy is pushing some Latin American governments to toe the U.S. line. But it could result in pushback from Latin Americans who don’t want to see a return of U.S. interventions in the region. It could also anger longtime U.S. allies. Prime Minister Mette Frederiksen of Denmark said any move by the U.S. on Greenland would mark the end of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization security alliance, a comment quickly backed up

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Diplomatic Efforts Gave Way to Military Action

President Trump grew frustrated after repeated attempts to persuade Maduro to leave office

Six months before he sent U.S. forces to seize Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro, President Trump wanted to cut a deal with Maduro,

By *Vera Bergengruen,*
Juan Forero, Alex Leary
and Kejal Vyas

not forcibly remove him from power. During a July meeting in the Oval Office, Trump told advisers that he

wanted to keep negotiating with Maduro’s regime to reach a deal to give priority to U.S. oil companies seeking to pump Venezuelan crude—opting for diplomacy with the autocratic leader.

Trump acknowledged that Secretary of State Marco Rubio, who had long cautioned him against trusting Maduro and believed oil revenues would bolster his regime, opposed the approach. But Trump, according to

people briefed on the discussion, said he wanted a deal: “We’re doing it my way.”

In late December, the president decided in favor of military action, fed up with repeated efforts to persuade Maduro to leave office in exchange for amnesty for his alleged crimes. The brazen overnight operation on Saturday ended with Maduro in a jail in New York.

In Trump’s second term, Venezuela

quickly became an unlikely convergence point for his priorities—mass deportations, drug trafficking, the lure of the country’s vast oil and mineral reserves, and a longstanding push by Rubio, the son of Cuban immigrants, and other hard-liners to depose its brutal regime.

“Venezuela is a perfect storm, it’s everything the Trump administration is concerned about,” said Elliott

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Hospitals Become Test Labs For AI

By TE-PING CHEN
AND CHAO DENG

Samir Abboud, chief of emergency radiology for Northwestern Medicine, thought he was already working at maximum speed. In a carefully honed routine, aided by voice dictation, he could finish writing an X-ray report in as little as 75 seconds.

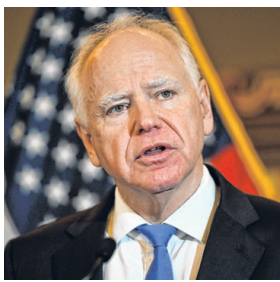
Then the Chicago-based health system rolled out generative artificial intelligence in 2024 that can analyze patient scans and write reports. Abboud, who checks the AI work for potential changes, said reviews have sped up to about 45 seconds.

The result was breathtaking—and startling. “It was the first time I felt like there was a clock on my career,” Abboud said.

Still, he said humans are a necessary part of the process. *Please turn to page A4*

◆ **MIT physicist pursues AI** safety campaign..... **B1**

INSIDE



CRAIG LASSIG/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

U.S. NEWS

Minnesota Gov. Tim Walz drops his bid for a third term, bruised by welfare scandal. **A3**



JASON GAY

In a great geezer revival, quarterback Aaron Rodgers is back in the playoffs. **A16**

South Korea’s President Identifies a New Enemy: Baldness

Push to cover hair-loss treatment parts country right down the middle

By TIMOTHY W. MARTIN
AND SOOYOUNG RHEE

SEOUL—At a televised policy meeting last month, South Korea President Lee Jae Myung launched into a seemingly banal discussion about healthcare. He noted people typically spend more on medical expenses as they age. Then

came a hair-raising turn.

“Hair loss is a disease, is it not?” the 61-year-old leader asked.

Lee, who has a voluminous head of hair, asked the country’s health minister whether the state-run healthcare plan could foot the bill for hair-loss treatment. He wants the fiscal *Please turn to page A9*

White House, Firms Win Key Concessions In Global Tax Deal

By RICHARD RUBIN

WASHINGTON—The Trump administration won international tax-policy concessions sought by Republicans and companies, reshaping the Biden-era global corporate minimum tax deal without abandoning it.

The U.S. had threatened to blow up the agreement last year, warning that it interfered with the nation’s prerogative to set its own tax policy. That prompted other countries to seek a path that would accommodate concerns from President Trump and congressional Republicans.

The U.S. paused those threats in late June, then the administration stayed at the negotiating table for the rest of 2025 to reach the consensus announced Monday by the Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development.

The updated agreement achieves two main U.S. aims. First, it prevents other countries from imposing taxes on U.S. companies based on the idea that U.S. companies pay too little tax on their U.S. oper-

ations. Second, it makes minimum-tax math more favorable to the U.S. research-and-development tax credit and similar incentives elsewhere. Those changes should shield U.S. companies from taxes that would otherwise hit them, and foreign-owned companies won some reprieves, too.

Keeping the U.S. inside the global deal is important because it shows continued international commitment to keeping a floor under corporate tax rates, Manal Corwin, the lead OECD official in the effort, said in an interview Monday.

“This outcome is a far better outcome than one that would have involved threats of retaliation or countries doing their own thing,” said Corwin, previously a senior Treasury Department official under then-President Barack Obama.

Monday’s announcement advances the politically fraught project to prevent what officials described as a race to the bottom in corporate tax rates, where companies could shrink tax bills by booking profits in low-tax ju- *Please turn to page A2*